

# Alejandro Velázquez

Lead Product Designer & Design Manager

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## SUMMARY

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Product design leader. Designing professionally since 2008, in payments and fintech since 2013, and in open banking since 2020, across Europe and Latin America. Founding designer at Yapily, where I built the design function from nothing and now lead a team of two across the platform. I work best on products where the experience isn't fully under design's control — regulated flows, API-first platforms, third-party dependencies — and where improvement has to be measured rather than asserted. Most of what I'm proudest of at Yapily is the apparatus: a research practice, event instrumentation and an in-house experimentation pipeline built alongside the design work, because without them there was no way to prove a change had helped.

## SKILLS

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User experience design · Interaction design · End-to-end journey design · Prototyping · Figma · Design systems · Design tokens · Accessibility (WCAG AA) · Inclusive design · User research · Usability testing · Experimentation and A/B testing · Product discovery · Information architecture · Content and UI craft · Design leadership · Design operations · Stakeholder management · Open banking · Payments · Regulated financial services · Enterprise SaaS · Platform and API-first products · Developer experience · HTML, CSS and JavaScript

## EXPERIENCE

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### Lead Product Designer and Design Manager, Founding Designer

Yapily · London, United Kingdom · Jan 2020 – Present

*Open banking infrastructure across the UK and Europe.*

- Joined as the company's first designer and built the design function. Now manage two product designers, owning hiring, onboarding and performance reviews; seven designers managed across six years as the team changed shape.
- Led strategy, design and launch of Hosted Pages, the white-label consent and bank-connection flow, spanning 1,500+ banks across 10+ countries at launch and over 2,000 across 19 countries today. Reduced customer integration effort from around six months to two weeks. Now used by 200 companies, drawn from a customer base that includes Google, Adyen, Intuit, Ant Financial and Revolut.
- Bank selection: time to find a bank fell from 5–15 seconds to 1–3 in most markets, and 3–5 in branch-heavy ones, through brand grouping, a popular-banks shortcut, display names matched to what people call their bank, and search alias gaps passed to engineering. Commissioned benchmarking had put competitors at 1–3 seconds.
- Other measurable movements: embedded login, roughly 13%, through bank-specific field mapping corrected in testing, A/B tested trust signals and per-bank retry limits; and the decoupled QR handoff, roughly 10%, in the regions where it was retained. Both directional, from overlapping production experiments rather than isolated tests.
- End-to-end conversion rose from around 20% at the 2023 beta to 65–75% today, moved incrementally by UX, frontend and backend together alongside expanding bank coverage. Design's share isn't cleanly separable from infrastructure gains, and I don't claim the figure as a design result.
- Three of the most valuable research findings weren't screen problems: bank display names didn't match what people call their bank; the search index held no aliases or retired brand names; and our retry handling enforced limits banks didn't actually impose. Each went to engineering as a data or logic change rather than a design change.
- Led accessibility work to WCAG AA. A commissioned audit found contrast failures and screen readers announcing raw SVG markup because alternative text was implemented incorrectly, leaving the flow unnavigable by screen reader. We postponed a release to fix both rather than ship and correct later; I documented the findings for the frontend team and the product now meets AA. A separate unmoderated study of 21 testers in Germany found 62% preferred the redesigned flow, rising to 78% among testers with disabilities.

- Built the research practice with no dedicated research function: 200+ customer interviews at a sustained monthly cadence since 2020, and a 2023–2026 programme of moderated and unmoderated end-user testing, sized to the decision in each case. Commissioned usability, accessibility and competitor benchmarking through Testbirds and Applause.
- Mapped the event instrumentation with engineering and product, then defined the experimentation pipeline with product and built it in-house, enabling A/B testing against production traffic and making the conversion claims above possible at all.
- Set up a bi-weekly feedback forum and shared prioritisation board with product, customer success, support and engineering, and restructured the documentation information architecture through card sorting, testing findability before and after.
- Mapped the end-to-end customer journey across sales, customer success, technical services, support and operations, and led the information architecture for the Console redesign that followed. Ran a two-day hackathon with engineering, product and implementation, role-playing as an outside consultancy using only what a real customer can access, to surface onboarding blockers.
- Split the Console path rather than replacing it: enterprise customers keep an assisted journey, everyone else gets self-serve. The 2026 beta covers KYB online, own bank portfolio, performance and billing visibility, team invites and integration tooling, with no conversation required at any step — in beta, so too early for adoption metrics. The Hosted Pages configurator shipped in full, giving customers self-serve control over every screen, previously a support ticket and an engineer per request.
- Built three design systems from scratch for different consumers — Yapily UI for internal tools, Custard as the white-label customer-facing foundation, and Mark for the marketing site — documented in Storybook and Figma on a three-tier token layer, now built against by around 38 engineers and 4 designers. The white-label system shares components with the internal one but inherits no brand, which is what makes customer self-serve theming possible without editing a component. Built the contribution and approval governance jointly with the frontend lead, and handed each established system to a designer on the team.
- Wrote Yapily's open banking UX guidance for customers building their own experiences — end-to-end flows, consent screens, consent dashboards, return and re-consent journeys, checkouts — as documentation plus interactive demos. Set the vision for demo.yapily.com, an indexed library of live journeys running real end-to-end flows against mock and live banks, and maintain it with my team.
- Led design across six rebrands and the yapily.com homepage redesign with marketing and two external agencies.
- Partnered with executive leadership on product strategy, prioritisation and platform vision, and supported the compliance team on FCA presentations. Worked with designers and product managers at Google over two years — the first year helping them build their own bank selection and authentication flows, after which they adopted Hosted Pages for account verification and for markets where per-market complexity made building it themselves uneconomic. Currently leading migration of the design systems into AI tooling as part of a company-wide AI transformation.

## Lead Product Designer

HeadBox · London, United Kingdom · Jan 2019 – Jan 2020

*Enterprise event technology and SaaS platform.*

- Led product design through a leadership transition with no reliable way to measure product performance. Fifteen customer interviews refocused the team on the enquiry-to-booking funnel, where only 20% of enquiries received a host proposal.
- Shipped the Enquiry Hub as a deliberately small experiment, London only and capped at £10k, which showed the platform connected hosts and guests well but converted poorly, and led to the pivot from marketplace to SaaS lead generation.
- Research established that expertise sat on the wrong side of the transaction: guests were making expert decisions while venue hosts, the actual experts, received unmatched leads they couldn't act on. Inverted the model — guests complete a requirements wizard, hosts choose from a lead feed — which changed the revenue model from sales commission to paid access and removed the incentive for off-platform leakage.
- Designed and launched the company's first SaaS product for venue partners, generating £150,228 ARR from 117 customers within three months, four times the prior model's performance. 1,500+ leads in the first month, with hosts logging in daily from launch after previous tools had failed to get them to log in at all. The wizard remains HeadBox's primary entry point. Also established the design system, governance framework and research practice used across the organisation.

## Product Design Lead

Su4erheroes (THEVAULT15 Ltd) · London, United Kingdom · Nov 2016 – Dec 2018

*Product design consultancy set up with former Payfriendz colleagues; Su4erheroes was the trading name. Company director from January 2018 to December 2018.*

- Principal client Docomo Digital, a global payments and commerce business: led design on NOMO, a payout platform built so marketplaces could handle third-party funds without becoming licensed payment institutions themselves — an internal admin console, a dashboard for marketplace owners, a mobile app for sellers, and API documentation. Also a consumer cashback app for Huawei customers, launched.
- Alongside it: Caremoni, an NHS personal health budget payments tool built with a social enterprise, taken to MVP and piloted; Mummybay, where research with parents ended the client's existing app and a marketplace replaced it; and our own products, Keymono and Colly, both piloted.

### **Lead Product Designer**

Payfriendz · London, United Kingdom · Oct 2013 – Nov 2016

*Digital wallet and peer-to-peer payments.*

- Directed mobile and web design across multiple releases with two designers and fifteen engineers, built the UI component system, and introduced the research and usability testing practices that informed prioritisation. £5M+ transferred by 150,000+ users; ranked #1–3 in the Apple App Store finance category.

### **Product Designer (Contract)**

Payango · Berlin, Germany · Jan 2013 – Oct 2013

*Worked remotely from Philadelphia, USA.*

- Designed user experiences for prepaid card, digital banking and payment products.

### **Designer**

Andimol · Argentina, then remote from the USA · Aug 2011 – Nov 2012

- Interaction design and UX/UI consultancy for Latin American firms.

### **Design Analyst**

Globant · Buenos Aires, Argentina · Sep 2008 – Aug 2011

- Designed enterprise products and digital experiences for organisations including Google, JP Morgan, PwC, Coca-Cola, Telefónica and Travelocity, within multidisciplinary product and engineering teams.

### **Designer, earlier career**

Sysnet Mexico (remote), Datasigma and independent · Argentina · 2005 – 2008

- Motion design for information screens; web design in CSS, HTML and CMS with direct client relationships; freelance design for small and medium businesses.

## **EDUCATION**

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### **Escuela Da Vinci**

Multimedia and Web Design · Buenos Aires, Argentina · 2002 – 2005

### **Universidad de Buenos Aires**

Human Resources (Relaciones Laborales) · Buenos Aires, Argentina · 1999 – 2002